



Ridge Preservation After Extraction

Purpose: Bone graft material placed into the extraction site to maintain bone for future implants.

First 24 Hours:

- Follow the same instructions as a simple extraction.
- Do not disturb the graft site by touching it with your tongue or fingers.
- Avoid swishing, spitting, or using a straw.

Pain & Swelling:

- Mild swelling and discomfort are normal.
- Use prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs 20 minutes on/off for the first day.

Bleeding:

- Slight bleeding or pink saliva is normal for 24–48 hours.
- If bleeding increases, apply firm pressure with gauze for 30 minutes.

Oral Hygiene:

- Avoid brushing directly over the graft site for 1 week.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinse as directed.
- Brush remaining teeth normally.

Diet:

- Soft foods for the first 3–4 days.
- Avoid seeds, nuts, chips, or foods that can get into the graft site.

Follow-Up:

- Contact the office if you see continuous loss of graft material after the first week.
- Healing will be evaluated at follow-up; implants are typically placed 3–6 months later.